
From Phosphate Mines to Diplomas... The History of Correctional Education in Florida
PART I — 1800-1970

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From Phosphate Mines to Diplomas . . . The History of Correctional Education in Florida

PART I — 1800-1970

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Abstract

Over two hundred years ago education for prisoners began in north America. The process of teaching inmates has changed, ended and begun again. This paper chronicles the history of prison education in the State of Florida. The issues of corrections and education have long been identified for the legislature and the citizens of Florida as being important. An understanding of how they coexist is important to the continuing success of both the educational and the correctional systems in Florida. From its beginning as religious teaching, this paper identifies the issues surrounding correctional education in Florida and the evolution of education within the prison setting.

Part II will appear in a following issue of the Journal of Correctional Education.

Two long-standing issues have been a concern for Floridians for many years; crime and education. Although most Floridians may not place the two issues together, over the last two decades, the two issues have gone hand-in-hand both through the Florida legislature and the public's perception of Florida as a safe state. Without dealing with "bleeding heart liberals" or "staunch conservatives," this paper will follow the development of prison education in Florida's penal system: when did it begin; why did it begin, who were the prisoners that were taught, who taught the prisoners, and how much did/does this cost the state of Florida? In order to do that, one must understand what correctional education is and how it began.

"The North American correctional education movement began in 1798, when clergyman William Rogers first offered instruction at Philadelphia's Walnut Street Jail. The warden was worried that a riot might result from this revolutionary initiative, so he required that two guards attend the meeting with a loaded cannon aimed directly at the convict students. Everything was peaceful, of course. This incident is indicative of the

struggle that has characterized teaching within prison walls ever since. Nevertheless, adult and juvenile correctional education has been on the 'cutting edge' of publicly funded education for approximately two hundred years..." (Gehring, 1991)

Over two hundred years ago, education for prisoners began. It was for no other reason than a clergyman was asked to do it and a warden, with hesitation, agreed he could try. Correctional education, then, and now can be defined as:

...the educational activities undertaken by persons who are under the supervision of the judiciary, whether sentenced or awaiting trial, and whether serving a sentence in jail, prison, or in the community.

...activities are focused on the perceived educational needs and interests of those under supervision of the judiciary.

...includes literacy and basic education, academic studies, vocational education and training, creative cultural activities, physical education and sport, and the accessing

of information resources. Interpersonal, communication, thinking and functional life skills may play a larger part in correctional education programs.

...activities offer opportunities to develop personal skills that may enable participants to act in a socially acceptable manner and to form and/or maintain relationships and vocational skills to gain and keep employment. Educational activities also serve as a vehicle for changing attitudes. Education may in this sense "correct" criminal behavior and contribute to rehabilitation/habilitation." (Bedford, 1996)

The rise of education within Florida's prisons can be viewed with the understanding of what correctional education is and when it began within North America.

Within the State of Florida, prisons trace back to the early 1800s. In 1821, county jails were used to house convicted felons. There is no record to indicate any form of education took place at this time. This arrangement for housing prisoners continued until the late 1860s. In 1867, Florida obtained the United States Arsenal property at Chattahoochee for use as the state prison. During this time, prisoners were used to help maintain the arsenal and little time remained for teaching or learning of any kind. In late 1869, the Florida Legislature passes the Penitentiary Act, placing the Commissioner of Public Institutions in charge of prisons. Under the Commissioner of Public Institutions, clergymen were permitted to provide religious teaching to prisoners on the Sabbath (Florida Department of Corrections [FDOC], 1996).

The arsenal remained the state prison until 1877 when it was abolished due to the need to house Florida's insane, which had previously been housed in Georgia and South Carolina. The prisoners, being few in number, were "let to a private concern operating a turpentine farm, where they worked for their up-keep" (Florida Department of Agriculture [FDA], 1946).

In 1877, the Commissioner of Agriculture was given the responsibility of supervising state prisons. The Commissioner of Agriculture leased prisoners to "corporations and individuals to work in phos-

phates mines and pine forests" (FDOC, 1996). All too often during this period, prisoners were brutally treated and worked eighty hours per week, leaving no time for education.

The Florida Constitution of 1885, Article 4, Section 26, officially prescribed that the Commissioner of Agriculture "shall also have supervision of the state prison, and shall perform such other duties as may be prescribed by law" (Florida Constitution, 1885). The Commissioner of Agriculture continued to lease Florida's prisoners to private concerns for labor purposes, and the brutal treatment and lack of education continued.

As a result of the brutal treatment through the lease program, property in Ocala was purchased for the purpose of establishing a central hospital for the care of the aging, crippled and infirm inmates in 1903. The Raiford State Penitentiary was established by the Florida Legislature in 1913 (FDOC, 1996). Records indicate this was the first state prison to house a library. Used for nothing more than pleasure reading during non-work hours, the library was an opening for further growth.

The Legislature, in 1917, created the State Road Department and the State Convict Road Force. Florida's inmates were now being used to build and maintain the state road system. In 1923, as a result of the death of a leased inmate, the Florida Legislature abolished the state convict lease system. The abolition of the lease system led to more inmates under the direct care of the State of Florida. As a result, prison industries were established to provide products to the public, while keeping inmates busy. The first prison industries were a shoe and shirt factory and an auto tag plant (FDOC, 1996). Although not officially documented as vocational training, prison industries were viewed as teaching inmates skills that could be used when released.

From the late 1920s through the late 1930s, no formal education existed in the state prison system. Clergymen and volunteers were permitted to hold religious teachings with inmates, but no formal education was taking place. By the early 1940s, Florida's prison population was changing.

"In the past, the prison population has been made up mostly of inmates of mature age and having past criminal records, today the picture is changing; prison population re-

flects a considerable number of teenage boys...The main purpose of this Institution is an effort to try to rehabilitate those who show a tendency to reform and lead useful lives after completing their term with us. In this Institution inmates will have the opportunity to learn vocational work, such as printing, masonry, farming, carpentry, etc. The advantages will be expanded as the situation demands." (FDA, 1950)

With the growth of a young population, the Department of Agriculture, Prison Division understood the need to rehabilitate and provide educational experiences for this population. The young inmates were not the only inmates to benefit from this concept. Apalachee Correctional Institution, located in Jackson County, was the institution built for the express purpose of serving the young criminal population.

In 1949, the first "First Section High School in the State Prison" was started at Raiford. The Prison Division stated, "Our aim is to afford every inmate a chance to equip himself with a basic training that will be of value to him when released from prison" (FDA, 1950). The school was strictly voluntary, but it was hoped that as many inmates as possible would improve basic skills and develop additional skills.

By 1951, the concept of prison school was developing. The Department of Education granted (13) state prisoners received high school equivalency diplomas in that year (Florida Correctional Education School Authority [FCESA], 1991). Although the two main programs were still in Raiford and Apalachee, the Prison Division requested capital outlay funds to build multipurpose buildings that could be used for teaching, recreation and religious functions. Local school districts began to see the need for education behind the prison walls. Superintendents understood the need for activities for maintaining the inmates during daylight hours, while at the same time providing them with skills to succeed when released from prison.

In 1955, Apalachee Correctional Institution, under the supervision of Superintendent Paul Eubanks, began "Apalachee's Five Point Program." Superintendent Eubanks described the program as providing inmates with another type of parental guidance; usually lacking for most of them. The Five Point

Program encompassed the following areas: academic training; vocational training; health and physical education, including leisure time activities; religious training; and social adjustment (FDA, 1956).

The main purpose of the academic training was to teach inmates the "4 'R's"—Reading, 'Riting, 'Rithmetic, and Responsibility—the main 'R' lacking in most individuals who came in contact with the correctional institution" (FDA, 1956). Vocational training consisted of thirty-five different fields of training in ten major trade areas. The trade fields were generally under the supervision of a skilled tradesman hired by the Prison Division as maintenance workers who supervised and taught the inmates while performing duties or functions that were part of daily prison operations. The goal of the vocational program was to place the inmate in a trade he had both an aptitude and interest to complete. This was accomplished through interviews, observations and tests designed to identify aptitudes and interests.

The administration at Apalachee Correctional Institution believed that many inmates were at the prison "because they had never learned to use their leisure time wisely" (FDA, 1956). For this reason, it was believed that all inmates should be provided with the opportunity to learn how to utilize their leisure time in appropriate manners. As for religious training, the main emphasis was to provide spiritual guidance for inmates and help them believe that they could function in society. The social adjustment was simply social education; group interaction and appropriate behavior for each situation. Various leisure time activities were coupled with the social adjustment program in an effort to provide inmates with "a sense of belonging" (FDA, 1956).

In 1956, the Department of Agriculture Prison Division opened the first female prison in Lowell, the Florida Correctional Institution. The women's facility was immediately staffed with academic and vocational programs for female inmates. Most programs were within the present stereotyping of the time, such as beauty culture, sewing and garment manufacturing, laundry operations, cooking, and waitressing.

In 1957, Florida adopted the Florida Correctional Code and established the Division of Corrections and removed the operation of the prison system from the Department of Agriculture and the Commis-

sioner. Programs at Apalachee, Raiford (Florida State Prison) and Florida Correctional Institutions continued to operate while the Division of Corrections was being established.

From July of 1958 through June of 1959, education within Florida's prisons grew dramatically. Apalachee Correctional Institution continued to add vocational trades to its training program. The institution had 18 major trade area programs. The women's facility continued to operate the basic vocational programs with academic education available to those in need. Avon Park Correctional Institution began academic classes geared toward the attainment of a high school diploma. Florida State Prison initiated a move for more academic and vocational program, adding an agriculture and general shop trades. At the close of the report period, approximately ten (10%) percent of the inmates at Florida State Prison were enrolled in the education program. All the adult institutions were now actively seeking opportunities to gain educational staff and support to further progress educational opportunities for the inmates (FDA, 1960).

During the next fiscal year, the educational opportunities for Black inmates are established at Glades State Farm Prison.

Although Glades State Farm Prison had been operational since 1932, inmates worked in the sugar cane fields and were not given the opportunity to participate in education programs. The Glades program was operated by the county school system with one academic instructor. The institution dedicated two classrooms, a library, and an office for the academic instructor and provided basic academic training. Through the use of volunteers and tutors, the teaching facilities were utilized to the fullest extent by operating the school in shifts (FDA, 1956).

As a routine function of intake procedures into the prison system, the Division of Corrections gave every inmate an I.Q. test. Additionally, education staff tested the inmates for appropriate grade levels prior to placement in academic classes. From July 1, 1959, through June 30, 1960, the greatest portion of inmates fell in the I.Q. range from 90 to 109. Table One indicates that when this same group of inmates was tested they fell into the following grade placement classifications.

It is obvious from these percentages that the Division of Corrections had a significant teaching

Table 1

Relative Grade Placement by Test	Percent of Inmates Received (Rounded)
0-4	13
5-8	62
9-11	17
Above 11	1
No Record	7
Total	100%

(FDA, 1956)

job ahead of them. To meet this challenge, the Division expanded educational facilities to the extent possible in view of the funds available. Florida State Prison, which housed almost forty percent (40%) of the inmate population had the following Education Department Assignments (Table 2).

Upon completion of academic training, inmates received the equivalent of a high school diploma and

Table 2

Education Department	
Assignments	No. of Inmates
Academic Classes	78
Vocational Training	31
Vocational Agriculture	25
Graphic Arts	17
Library Staff	4
Assistant Instructors	15
Clerks	6
Janitors	4
Total Assigned	180

(FDA, 1961)

upon completion of vocational training a certificate of vocational achievement. Both these types of training were geared toward helping the inmate better himself to be successful upon release from prison. The training also helped many inmates secure better jobs within the prison system, because they were educated and trained.

At Florida Correctional Institution, there were 62 inmates enrolled in school on June 30, 1960 (FDA, 1961). Activities began in the area of expanding vocational trades to offer business type trades, (typing, shorthand, bookkeeping), and 20 female inmates received high school diplomas from the institution's educational program.

Apalachee Correctional Institution, which housed the male youthful offenders, had the largest education program. The Education Department had the following educational assignments as of June 30, 1960 as indicated in Table 3:

Of these academic assignments, 16 inmates received high school diplomas during the fiscal year.

Table 3	
Education Department	
Assignments	No. of Inmates
Regularly Assigned Jobs in Dept.	10
School Enrollment:	
Primary	90
Secondary	124
High School	109
Night Study Classes	48
Total Assigned	381
(Florida Division of Corrections, 1961)	

It is important to note that all inmates at Apalachee were involved in some kind of vocational training. Although the Division did not officially report this participation as a vocational enrollment, they did state that all inmates receive "an opportunity to learn a skilled trade" (Florida Division of Corrections, 1961).

Avon Park Correctional Institution housed older and inmates with physical disabilities. The main emphasis at Avon Park had been academics, as the Division was uncertain how older handicapped inmates would receive vocational training. During the year however, the Division saw the advantage of training all inmates and began vocational courses in auto mechanics, hotel and restaurant management, and conversational Spanish. Avon Park's Education De-

partment had 46 inmates enrolled on a full time basis and an additional 58 enrolled in night school (Florida Division of Corrections, 1961). The educational staff also "developed an excellent Correspondence (Extension) Program, which was designed to reach inmates who are not able to attend regular classes" (Florida Division of Corrections, 1961). This program was used not only by the institution's inmates who were assigned to full day work crews, but also the State Road Prisons, where little or no educational facilities were available.

It is significant to note that in June, 1960, the Florida Correctional Education Association was organized. The purpose of the association was/is "to promote the standards of penal education and provide for a greater exchange of ideas between the various educators and counselors in the state correctional system" (Florida Division of Corrections, 1961). Before this time, the education departments within the various prisons across the state had operated in an independent and non-communicative status. County school system personnel came in and taught classes without much regard for communication. The organization of the Florida Correctional Education Association was an attempt to give prison educators a forum for discussion and connect them with other prison educators not only in the state, but across the nation.

During the July 1, 1960, to June 30, 1962, biennium, the Division of Corrections reported 500 inmates received General Equivalency Diplomas (GED's). All the major institutions were reporting success with the educational programs. Apalachee, Avon Park, Florida, Florida State, and Glades were all operational and reporting sizable school enrollments. With the majority of Education Department teachers coming from local school districts, education programs operated on a September to July school term with various other classes being offered during the summer months (Florida Division of Corrections, 1962).

At Florida Correctional Institution, the Education Department was divided into two schools: academic and business. Within the academic school, (39) inmates received General Equivalency Diplomas (Florida Division of Corrections, 1962). Within the business school, two inmates received Business Certificates and an additional 14 received awards of completion of one or more of the offered subjects.

"During this period, the Education Department made use of the Science Program televised over Channel 5 (educational television)" (Florida Division of Corrections, 1962). It was felt that this televised programming offered a great latitude in the institution's Education Program. Three inmates completed correspondence courses, while one inmate took extension courses from the University of Florida.

It was specifically reported that "both teachers and supervisor attended all meetings of the Florida Correctional Education Association" (Florida Division of Corrections, 1962). It should also be noted that the Education Department at Florida Correctional Institution printed all forms, classification reports, church bulletins, and special-events programs for the institution. This is the first example of the use of education in the provision of daily operation services for the institution. Although there is no official report of segregation of education services reports, it is clearly established that the institution has two choirs—"one colored and one white" (Florida Division of Corrections, 1962). The White choir reportedly took trips outside the institution to perform at various meetings and functions for the Division of Corrections; however, there was no mention of the Black choir doing so.

Florida State Prison and Apalachee Correctional Institution still operated the largest education departments in the Division. Florida State Prison reported "115 diplomas and certificates of achievement were awarded—62% of enrolled students completed educational goals" (Florida Division of Corrections, 1962). The Florida State Prison received support from the Florida Development Commission in establishing new vocational trades through the donation of equipment and supplies otherwise unobtainable.

During this biennium period, Glades Correctional Institution, formerly Glades State Farm Prison, made history, as the first three Black inmates earned their GED High School Equivalency Certificates (Florida Division of Corrections, 1962).

The Road Prisons, which primarily served the Division's commitment to the State Road Department began to be viewed as viable places for education. The Division had worked with the State Department of Education's Adult Education Division to provide educational programs at the Road

Prisons. "At present, 30 of the 36 Road Prisons have educational programs offering the inmate an opportunity to obtain a high school diploma" through the provision of night classes (Florida Division of Corrections, 1962). These programs were provided through the local county Adult Education Departments. It was the Division's desire that all 36 Road Prison have educational programs.

The Division of Corrections made appreciable progress in the field of education during this biennium. There were now a total of 29 full-time certified academic instructors employed. Over 370 General Equivalency Diplomas were awarded to inmates and vocational programs expanded across the state. Educational programs continued at the Road Prisons with 32 of the 36 Road Prisons having evening classes conducted by local school board teachers under the minimum foundations program with funds from the State Department of Education (Florida Division of Corrections, 1964).

In 1962, the Division began to look for ways to expand vocational opportunities without hiring additional staff. The Division worked with the Department of Education to have "all supervisory personnel in the areas of food service, garment manufacturing, medical services, machinery maintenance and laundry operations certified as instructors" (Florida Division of Corrections, 1964). The certified instructors provided a training program consisting of classroom instruction and on-the-job training. After approval by the State Department of Education, these on-the-job training programs were permitted to award vocational certificates when an inmate completed the prescribed course of study and specified amount of time in the on-the-job training position. While this operation allowed for the Division to increase the number of vocational certificates being awarded, it did not necessarily offer the inmates better vocational training. Many on-the-job training positions were support positions for the daily operation of the institution. Although the on-the-job training positions did provide exposure and training in a specific field, the training was often limited to the daily needs and/or emergency needs of the institution as opposed to a hierarchy of skills and abilities needed for the specific trade.

In 1964, the Division of Corrections was reorganized and the education programs were placed under the Inmate Treatment section of the Division

of Corrections Central Office. In the field, Education Departments were still directly responsible to the institution superintendents, but the Inmate Treatment section provided "primary emphasis on improving present program and procedures as well as planning and helping to implement new programs of inmate rehabilitation" (Florida Division of Corrections, 1966). As an added emphasis to the importance of education, the Division adds an Education Counselor to the Central Office staff in the Inmate Treatment Section.

The Division, as a whole, boasted "thirty-nine full-time certified teaching positions in the major institutions, and in addition, approximately sixty-five public school teachers conduct classes at the Road Prisons" (Florida Division of Corrections, 1966). The sixty-five public school teachers covered all thirty-six Road Prisons, the first time all Road Prisons had educational programs. Five Road prisons also had vocational courses being taught through local county school systems.

The Division had some additional firsts during this biennium, the beginning of slow learner classes at Florida State Prison and the offering of college courses at Panama City Road Prison by nearby junior colleges. The Division awarded 570 General Equivalency and Adult Education Diplomas, and certificates in ten vocational areas (Florida Division of Corrections, 1966).

In 1966, as a result of studies and statistics gathered by the Division which indicated that "over eighty percent of Florida inmates have less than a high school education with nearly fifty percent below the ninth grade level", the Division established a purpose for the educational programs (Florida Division of Corrections, 1968).

"The purpose of the Division's educational program is to provide for the inmate, the agents (teachers) and agencies (schools) that will properly motivate and bring about necessary changes that should lead to appreciation of adult learning and adult education. In addition, this program should provide the academic and vocational training necessary for the inmates to support and care for themselves and their responsibility after release from prison." (Florida Division of Corrections, 1968)

The Division's educational programs were attended by approximately 2,000 inmates in academic classes. These academic classes were managed by certified academic principals and instruction was provided through twenty full-time professional educational teachers and many inmate teachers, in the seven major institutions and by seventy part-time teachers from local county school systems at the Road Prisons. The academic program was highlighted by 710 inmates receiving the State of Florida General Education Development Diploma (GED) and 30 others receiving high school diplomas issued by credits. An additional 1,200 inmates enrolled in forty-six (46) colleges courses. One inmate completed all the course work for the Associate of Arts Degree by transferring thirty credit hours earned from the University of Florida prior to incarceration (CESA, 1991).

Vocational programs continued to grow during this biennium with coordination of activities by "two vocational training coordinators" and training being conducted by three major methods (CESA, 1991). At major institutions, school personnel provided vocational programs and worked cooperatively with supervisory personnel around the institutions to provide the "Formalized On-The-Job Training Program." The third method was the part-time programs offered at the Road Prisons by the local county school systems. The most concentrated efforts were again aimed at the Formalized On-The-Job Program with 175 vocational instructors certified by the State Department of Education to teach vocational trades in such areas as: basic dental laboratory technician; furniture repair and finishing; basic automotive mechanics; automotive suspension, steering and alignment; basic electricity; cosmetology; laundry; carpentry; baking; cooking; table waiting; and meat cutting (CESA, 1991).

In late 1966, the Division began looking at long range planning. With the assistance of Florida State University, the Department of Adult Education and the State Department of Education, an education plan was developed for the Division of Corrections. A bill that provided an "additional 1.5 million dollars for adult correctional education was passed by both houses of the legislature and signed by the Governor" (Florida Division of Corrections, 1968).

This was Florida's first stand for education in prison. Until this time, it was acceptable to acquire

educational services through the local school system, or utilize a group of inmate teachers to teach. This is the first time that funds were specifically allocated for educational purposes and the first time positions, "over 100 professional positions for education in corrections" were established by the legislature (CESA, 1991). It is here that the ground work began for studies of correctional education and its impact on employability and success at remaining a free citizen within the state of Florida.

During 1968, "the Florida public demonstrated more than just passive curiosity about schooling for inmates." For the first time, educators within the prison system were given materials in an effort to update "out-dated and ineffective teaching practices." The 1.5 million dollar appropriation coupled with existing funding and one million dollars in federal grants "provided 2.5 million dollars per year for inmates educational programs" during the 1968-1970 biennium (Florida Division of Corrections, 1970).

Of significant impact was the additional personnel established with the increased funds. In prior years, there were only 39 certified positions, and of those only 26 were direct service teachers. The educational staff increased from thirty-nine to one hundred thirty-four full-time positions, "all requiring a minimum of a four year college degree and certification by the State Department of Education" (Florida Division of Corrections, 1970). The Division still employed approximately eighty part-time teachers from the local school systems to provide instruction at the Road Prisons.

At the twelve major institutions, both general academic classes with achievement toward a high school diploma and college courses with achievement toward an Associate of Arts degree were offered. Over 3000 inmates were enrolled in academic classes with 991 inmates graduating by passing the General Education Development test. College courses achieved an enrollment of 2416 for one hundred and eight different courses with five inmates earning Associate of Arts Degrees (Florida Division of Corrections, 1970). Additionally, Education Coordinator, Dave Enwright, entered into an agreement with the Division of Vocational Rehabilitation to provide services to "physically and mentally disabled inmates who appear to be able to profit from vocational rehabilitation services" and were

close to release. This assistance ranged from counseling and guidance to vocational training and job placement assistance (Florida Division of Corrections, 1970).

Vocational training opportunities continued to emphasize the formalized on-the-job training programs, but had added apprenticeships, shop-lab instruction, and "Manpower Development Training" (Florida Division of Corrections, 1970). Florida Correctional Institution took a leap ahead with the establishment of a School of Cosmetology, providing a State-approved 1200 hour vocational course that enabled students to earn their junior operators licenses while confined. A federal grant permitted the Division to equip vocational shops to specially train disadvantaged and inmates with disabilities. The Division issued 502 inmates Vocational Certificates of Achievement (Florida Division of Corrections, 1970). Under the new initiative of support, the Division became "the only state in the nation that has authorized certified librarian positions in each of its major correctional institutions" (Florida Division of Corrections, 1970). The librarians replaced old hand-me-down collections with new excellent reading material.

As a result of the large appropriation, the Division had the opportunity to provide testing, counseling, and guidance services to the inmate population. The process started at reception centers with interviews of all inmates. During the reception process, inmates received an academic achievement test, a vocational interest and the General Aptitude Test Battery (GATB) was administered to inmates who had a ninth grade reading level. Test scores and other pertinent information were recorded on an inmate education folder "(DC-61)" that is forwarded to the permanent institution to which the inmate is assigned following reception processing (Florida Division of Corrections, 1970). Qualified educational and guidance counseling personnel at the major institutions continued with both group and individual counseling sessions as a part of the total overall educational program for all inmates.

Once again, during the 1970-1972 biennium Florida's Division of Corrections was embarking on new territory. In Community Correctional Centers, the Division began an education release program. This program had approximately 45 men and women regularly leaving different facilities to attend college

level courses Florida Division of Corrections, 1971). Although started on a small scale, the Division viewed this initiative as a positive start to reintegrating inmates into the communities.

Throughout much of the state, correctional education was now seen as an integral part of the total rehabilitation process for changing deviant behavior. The basic objective was to provide every individual with academic, vocational, or social living skills needed to return to society as self-fulfilled and productive citizen. During the past biennium, the Florida Legislature had been financing correctional education at an average rate of \$1,982,136.00 annually (Florida Division of Corrections, 1971). The result of the legislative appropriation combined with new construction moneys and federal grants had provided the Division with "\$3,536,030. per year for inmate education" (Florida Division of Corrections, 1971). Since 1968, an additional seventy-six positions had been added with this funding, increasing the total number of positions to 220.

The additional staff positions increased the daily capacity for academic students to more 3700 inmates enrolled in literacy training, pre-vocational preparation, and high school equivalency classes. Nine-hundred and twenty inmates received general equivalency diplomas during the two year biennium (Florida Division of Corrections, 1971).

Ten more vocational shops were equipped and placed into active educational status with federal dollars, and a "Division-wide Vocational Plan was developed and endorsed by the Florida Department of Education." If the plan was fully funded by the legislature, every inmate who lacked employable skills would receive intensive school-centered vocational instruction at some point during incarceration (Florida Division of Corrections, 1971).

The Division utilized the services of a state university music student to upgrade institutional music programs. "Following his recommendations, plans were formulated to broaden existing music programs and make them more responsive to the instructional, therapeutic, and entertainment needs of the inmates" (Florida Division of Corrections, 1972). The music program was a viable learning avenue for many inmates.

Conclusion

Through the decades, the Florida prison system

has undergone significant changes in the provision of education and the public interest in education behind prison walls. Coming from a nonexistent system in the late 1860s to receiving a total of \$3,536,030 in state and federal dollars in the beginning of the 1970s, was a sizable accomplishment for an agency which began under the auspices of the Commissioner of Agriculture. This new interest by the public, and the monetary commitment by the legislature, would prove to be a formidable challenge for the Division of Corrections in the coming decades.

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Biographical Sketches

Dr. Laufersweiler-Dwyer, Assistant Professor, University of Arkansas at Little Rock, specializes in substance abuse, serial crime, organization and administration, and victimology. Her research includes stress within CJ agencies, quality of life issues, evaluation of substance abuse treatment programs and rule violation by inmate populations. She has authored presentations and articles on minority representation in crime film genre, stress, serial killers, distance learning, program assessment and informal learning in police organizations.

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Historical Vignette

Detecting Insincerity

In 1870 Professor Tarbell, who taught at the Detroit House of Correction, emphasized the need for integrity in an institutional teacher: "He must be a painstaking, consistent, steadfast man, of so much character and scholarship as to secure the respect and confidence of the prisoners. There must be no sham, no mere assumption about him for [of] all shrewd observers of men and motives, of all lynx-eyed detectors of hum-bug and affectation, the inmates of our prisons are the sharpest." (Tarbell, in Wallack, W., 1939, Correctional Education Today, New York: APA, pp. 7-8). In the 1930s Father Flanagan, the founder of Boys Town, agreed that even the roughest "boys can detect truth from counterfeit...quicklyThey can perceive weakness and hypocrisy in your eyes before you even open your mouth and remove all doubt." (Oursler, F., and Oursler, W., Father Flanagan of Boys Town, Garden City, NY: Doubleday, p. 5).